



Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey

Quarterly Report

1st Quarter - 2026

SRI LANKA LABOUR FORCE SURVEY

**Quarterly Report – 2026
First Quarter**

**Department of Census and Statistics
Ministry of Finance, Planning and Economic Development**

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Preface

Department of Census and Statistics has a long history of conducting the Labour Force Survey (LFS) in Sri Lanka. For instance, before 1990 this survey was conducted at every five yearly time intervals and from 1990 onward it was conducted as a regular survey to provide quarterly and annual labour force indicators. Labour Force Surveys provide various labour force indicators including employment and unemployment status of the country. Specially the survey provides necessary information to compile GDP and other important economic indicators of the country.

Various improvements were incorporated into the LFS during past period without breaking its core concepts and definitions which were used since 1990. In 2006, new modules were added to the LFS to capture the information on computer literacy, household economic activities and informal sector employment. The structure of the LFS questionnaire which was used during 2006-2012 was revised in 2013 with new improvements for concepts and classifications used. It is important to note that in 2013 the definition of working age population was revised from age ten and above population to age fifteen and above population.

In 2026, published labour force estimates of 2025 were revised based on the population estimates of the Census of Population and Housing which was conducted in 2024. This revision was done along with the international best practices.

Another major achievement for data collection for LFS was taken place in 2017 with the introduction of Computer Assisted Data Collection (CAPI) using tablet computers. Before 2017 enumerators used paper based method and used survey questionnaires to record the answers given by the respondents. A known probability sampling technique is used to select the sample and the annual labour force indicators are compiled using 25,000 housing units covering the entire country. The enumerators who are permanent officers of the Department visited each of these randomly selected housing units to collect the information with a great effort. The field work of the survey for the first quarter 2026 was done in the month of January, February and March in year 2026. This report is based on the data collected in quarterly sample of 6,250 housing units.

I hope the information in this report is very valuable and useful to make evidence based decisions for various users to identify the issues as well as the changes in the labour market of Sri Lanka.

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Acknowledgements

This report is the hundred and thirty eighth in the series of the Quarterly Labour Force Survey which was commenced from the first quarter of 1990 and is being continued by the Department of Census and Statistics.

Planning and execution of the survey was done by the staff of the Sample Surveys Division under the guidance of Ms. K.M.D.S.D. Karunaratne, Director General (Statistics) and under the direction of Dr(Ms). M.D.D.D. Deepawansa, Director (Statistics), Sample Surveys Division.

The survey activities were organized and supervised by Ms. U.S. Dilrukshi, Mr. L.S.N. Perera, Ms. M.W.L.C.M. Chandrarathne, Ms. M.M.G.D Manamperi, Ms. R.P.M. Subhashini, Ms. W.A.S. Malkanthi, Mr. H.M.S.C. Bandara, Ms. I.S. Hamangoda, Ms. C.R. Liyanage and Ms. A.H.L.T. Sandaruwini, Statisticians, of the Sample Surveys Division, under the guidance of Mr. J. Liyanage and Ms. W.A.D.R.D. Athukorala, Deputy Directors (Statistics), Sample Surveys Division.

The computer data processing and final tabulations were done by Mr. A.M.A.E. Atapattu Statistical Officer of the Sample Surveys Division, under the supervision of Ms. M.W.L.C.M. Chandrarathne, Statistician. The Statistical Officers, Development Officers, Information and Communication Technology Assistants and Data Entry Operators/ Coding Clerks of the Sample Survey Division are acknowledged for their valuable contribution during the whole survey process.

The Information & Communication Technology Division, Mr. P.D.D. Peiris and Mr. E.M.D. Ekanayake, Directors (ICT) were responsible for implementing CAPI methodology and preparation of data collection and computer edits programmes.

This publication was organized and prepared by Ms. M.W.L.C.M. Chandrarathne, Statistician, Sample Surveys Division, assisted by Mr. A.M.A.E. Atapattu Statistical Officer, under the guidance of Dr(Ms). M.D.D.D. Deepawansa, Director (Statistics) and Ms. W.A.D.R.D. Athukorala, Deputy Director (Statistics), Sample Surveys Division.

District staff of the Department who worked on the survey deserves a special word of thanks. The Deputy Directors/ Statisticians supervised the survey and field Statistical Officers, worked hard at the data collection stage, to make this survey a success.

Finally, I wish to express my appreciation to all the respondents of the survey for their valuable cooperation.

Selected Labour Force Indicators

Indicator	Year / Quarter									
	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025	2024Q1	2025Q1	2026Q1
Labour force participation rate										
By Gender										
Total	52.3	50.6	49.9	49.8	48.6	47.4	49.4	47.1	49.7	49.2
Male	73.0	71.9	71.0	70.5	68.6	67.4	69.1	67.2	70.1	69.1
Female	34.5	32.0	31.8	32.1	31.3	29.8	32.4	29.6	32.0	32.5
By residential sector										
Total	52.3	50.6	49.9	49.8	48.6	47.4	49.4	47.1	49.7	49.2
Urban	50.2	47.0	46.9	47.2	46.0	44.3	46.5	46.3	47.0	46.7
Rural*	52.7	51.3	50.5	50.3	49.1	48.0	49.9	47.2	50.2	49.8
Unemployment Rate										
By Gender										
Total	4.8	5.5	5.1	4.7	4.7	4.4	3.9	4.5	3.8	3.7
Male	3.3	4.0	3.7	3.7	3.6	3.0	2.8	3.1	2.5	2.4
Female	7.4	8.5	7.9	6.5	7.0	7.1	6.1	7.4	6.3	6.1
By selected age Group (Year)										
20 - 29	15.3	18.1	18.3	16.2	17.0	16.1	13.9	16.8	13.9	13.7
20 - 24	20.3	25.2	26.8	21.8	21.6	20.7	17.8	20.7	18.3	15.8
25 - 29	11.0	12.0	11.4	11.7	13.0	12.5	10.6	13.7	10.2	11.8
By selected educational level										
GCE A/L and above										
Total	8.5	9.8	9.1	7.8	8.0	7.8	6.0	8.3	6.1	6.5
Male	5.0	6.2	6.2	5.5	5.8	5.4	3.9	5.8	4.2	3.2
Female	11.9	13.6	12.2	10.1	10.2	10.3	8.3	11.0	8.3	9.7
Employed population										
By Gender										
Total	8,180,693	7,999,093	8,113,507	8,147,731	8,009,916	7,949,751	8,079,040	7,901,693	8,086,773	8,102,868
Male	5,368,896	5,372,947	5,414,280	5,373,965	5,307,563	5,358,554	5,299,777	5,320,151	5,367,570	5,274,509
Female	2,811,796	2,626,146	2,699,228	2,773,766	2,702,354	2,591,197	2,779,262	2,581,542	2,719,203	2,828,359
By industry (Percentage)										
Total	8,180,693	7,999,093	8,113,507	8,147,731	8,009,916	7,949,751	8,079,040	7,901,693	8,086,773	8,102,868
%	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
Agriculture	2,071,940	2,169,679	2,213,015	2,158,559	2,088,344	2,066,651	1,932,548	2,039,574	1,889,295	1,920,505
%	25.3	27.1	27.3	26.5	26.1	26.0	23.9	25.8	23.4	23.7
Industry	2,258,421	2,152,746	2,109,482	2,158,199	2,043,154	2,031,417	2,120,455	1,949,786	2,123,863	2,096,104
%	27.6	26.9	26.0	26.5	25.5	25.6	26.2	24.7	26.3	25.9
Services	3,850,332	3,676,668	3,791,011	3,830,973	3,878,418	3,851,683	4,026,037	3,912,333	4,073,615	4,086,258
%	47.1	46.0	46.7	47.0	48.4	48.5	49.8	49.5	50.4	50.4
By no. of hours worked per week (percentage)										
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
0**	6.4	14.6	9.6	5.8	4.2	2.5	2.6	2.7	1.6	2.4
1 - 9	1.7	2.1	2.0	2.1	2.4	1.8	2.0	1.9	1.6	2.2
10 - 39	26.8	27.1	29.6	31.9	31.2	28.3	28.7	29.7	28.1	26.9
40 & above	65.1	56.2	58.7	60.3	62.1	67.4	66.7	65.8	68.7	68.5

* The 'rural sector' encompasses rural, urban estates and rural estates

** Has a job but not at work during the reference week

Note : Working age population considered as (age 15 & over population)

Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey 2026 First Quarter Summary Statistics on Labour Force Characteristics

15 years & over population

	Total	Male	Female	Urban	Rural*
Population (15 years & over)	17,089,315	7,817,410	9,271,905	2,887,696	14,201,619
Labour force in this age group	8,414,363	5,401,458	3,012,905	1,347,887	7,066,476
Labour force participation rate	49.2	69.1	32.5	46.7	49.8
Employed population	8,102,868	5,274,509	2,828,359	1,310,753	6,792,114
Employment rate	96.3	97.6	93.9	97.2	96.1
Unemployed population	311,495	126,950	184,546	37,134	274,362
Unemployment rate	3.7	2.4	6.1	2.8	3.9
Not in labour force	8,674,952	2,415,951	6,259,001	1,539,809	7,135,143

18 years & over population

	Total	Male	Female	Urban	Rural*
Population (18 years & over)	16,019,851	7,260,327	8,759,524	2,721,157	13,298,694
Labour force in this age group	8,384,881	5,375,418	3,009,463	1,347,569	7,037,313
Labour force participation rate	52.3	74.0	34.4	49.5	52.9
Employed population	8,084,654	5,258,852	2,825,802	1,310,435	6,774,219
Employment rate	96.4	97.8	93.9	97.2	96.3
Unemployed population	300,227	116,566	183,661	37,134	263,093
Unemployment rate	3.6	2.2	6.1	2.8	3.7
Not in labour force	7,634,970	1,884,909	5,750,061	1,373,588	6,261,382

20 years & over population

	Total	Male	Female	Urban	Rural*
Population (20 years & over)	15,389,054	6,938,865	8,450,189	2,621,805	12,767,249
Labour force in this age group	8,269,399	5,281,888	2,987,512	1,326,755	6,942,645
Labour force participation rate	53.7	76.1	35.4	50.6	54.4
Employed population	7,983,556	5,174,171	2,809,385	1,294,267	6,689,289
Employment rate	96.5	98.0	94.0	97.6	96.4
Unemployed population	285,844	107,717	178,127	32,488	253,356
Unemployment rate	3.5	2.0	6.0	2.4	3.6
Not in labour force	7,119,654	1,656,978	5,462,677	1,295,050	5,824,605

* The 'rural sector' encompasses rural, urban estates and rural estates

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

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Appendix 1: Explanatory Notes

Appendix 2: Alternative estimates of employment, unemployment and labour force characteristics

Labour Force

All persons aged 15 years & over who are currently economically active during the reference period (Labour Force = employed persons + unemployed persons)

Reference Period:

Previous week of the survey week
(3rd week of every month)

Labour force participation rate (LFPR)

Labour force as a percentage of the population aged 15 years and over.

Labour Force (Economically Active Population)

Table 1: Economically active population by gender and sector, first quarter - 2026

Sector	Economically Active Population					
	Total	%	Male	%	Female	%
Sri Lanka	8,414,363	100	5,401,458	64.2	3,012,905	35.8
Urban	1,347,887	100	881,288	65.4	466,599	34.6
Rural	6,722,604	100	4,313,632	64.2	2,408,972	35.8
Estate*	343,872	100	206,539	60.1	137,333	39.9

* The 'estate sector' encompasses both urban estates and rural estates

Table 2: Economically inactive population by gender and sector, first quarter - 2026

Sector	Economically Inactive Population					
	Total	%	Male	%	Female	%
Sri Lanka	8,674,952	100	2,415,951	27.8	6,259,001	72.2
Urban	1,539,809	100	430,260	27.9	1,109,549	72.1
Rural	6,787,461	100	1,884,213	27.8	4,903,248	72.2
Estate*	347,682	100	101,478	29.2	246,203	70.8

* The 'estate sector' encompasses both urban estates and rural estates

According to the Table 1, the estimated economically active population is about 8.4 million in the first quarter 2026. Of which 64.2 percent are males and 35.8 percent are females. The economically inactive population is about 8.7 million. Out of the economically inactive population 27.8 percent are males and 72.2 percent are females (Table 2).

Table 3: LFPR by gender and year, 2021 - 2026Q1

Year	Total	Male	Female
2021	49.9	71.0	31.8
2022	49.8	70.5	32.1
2023	48.6	68.6	31.3
2024	47.4	67.4	29.8
2025	49.4	69.1	32.4
2024 Q1	47.7	67.6	30.3
2025 Q1	49.7	70.1	32.0
2026 Q1	49.2	69.1	32.5

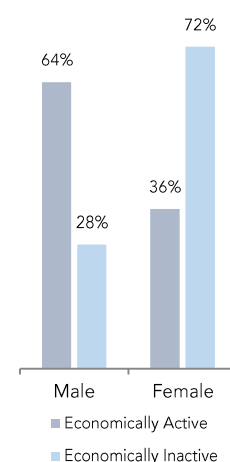
Table 3 provides the information on LFPRs by gender since year 2021. Referring the Table 3, it is important to note that, male participation to the labour force is always higher than that of female.

Table 4: LFPR by age group and gender, first quarter - 2026

Age group (Years)	Total	Male	Female
Sri Lanka	49.2	69.1	32.5
15 - 19	8.5	13.6	3.1*
20 - 24	50.3	64.3	37.8
25 - 29	66.9	87.6	50.1
30 - 34	66.5	95.5	41.9
35 - 39	67.2	96.9	43.9
40 - 44	70.6	94.6	50.4
45 - 49	71.5	95.2	50.9
50 - 54	65.1	90.6	43.6
55 - 59	59.3	84.0	38.5
60+	26.9	44.5	13.4

*These Figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of Variation) Values are high.

Figure 1: Distribution of economically active vs inactive population, first quarter 2026



Considering the Table 4, the distribution of LFPR by age group and by gender depicts high male participation compared to female in all age groups. The highest participation rate for male is reported from age group 35 - 39 years (96.9%), while that for female is reported from 45 - 49 age group (50.9%).

Employment**Employed**

Persons, who worked at least one hour during the reference period, as paid employees, employers, own account workers or contributing family workers are said to be employed. This also includes persons with a job but not at work during the reference period.

Employment Rate

The proportion of employed population to the total labour force.

Table 5: Distribution of employed population by main industry (first quarter 2025 - first quarter 2026)

Quarter	Sri Lanka	Major Industry Group		
		Agriculture	Industries	Services
2025 Q1	8,139,605	1,906,832	2,135,102	4,097,671
(%)	100.0	23.4	26.2	50.3
2025 Q2	8,172,638	2,104,353	2,063,914	4,004,372
(%)	100.0	25.7	25.3	49.0
2025 Q3	8,097,879	1,896,470	2,166,884	4,034,524
(%)	100.0	23.4	26.8	49.8
2025 Q4*	8,036,367	1,854,939	2,115,117	4,066,311
(%)	100	23.1	26.3	50.6
2026 Q1	8,102,868	1,920,505	2,096,104	4,086,258
(%)	100	23.7	25.9	50.4

* Corrected

Table 5 shows the percentage distribution of employed population by main industry from first quarter 2025 to first quarter 2026. During first quarter of 2026, the total number of employed persons in Sri Lanka is estimated as 8.1 million. Of which, about 50.4 percent engaged in service sector, 25.9 percent in industry sector and 23.7 percent in agriculture sector. In the first quarter of 2026, there are increases in employed persons in agriculture sector compared to the first quarter of 2025.

Main industry categories and sub sectors

Agriculture

Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery (A)

Industries

1. Mining & Quarrying (B)
2. Manufacturing (C)
3. Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E, F)

Services

1. Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles (G)
2. Transportation and storage (H)
3. Accommodation and food services activities (I)
4. Information and communication (J)
5. Financial and insurance activities (K)
6. Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)
7. Administrative and support service activities (N)
8. Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)
9. Education (P)
10. Human health and social work activities (Q)
11. Other service activities (S)
12. Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)
13. Real estate activities (L) Arts, entertainment and recreation (R) Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 6: Distribution of employed population by employment status in agriculture and non - agriculture sectors, first quarter - 2026

Employment Status	Sector					
	Sri Lanka		Agriculture		Non-Agriculture	
	No.	%	No.	%	No.	%
Sri Lanka	8,102,868	100.0	1,920,505	23.7	6,182,362	76.3
Employee	4,948,609	100.0	679,531	13.7	4,269,078	86.3
Public	1,177,807	100.0	34,998*	3.0*	1,142,809	97.0
Private	3,770,801	100.0	644,533	17.1	3,126,269	82.9
Employer	240,334	100.0	19,455*	8.1*	220,879	91.9
Own Account Worker	2,537,467	100.0	998,299	39.3	1,539,168	60.7
Contributing Family Worker	376,457	100.0	223,220	59.3	153,237	40.7

*These Figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of Variation) Values are high.

According to the Table 6 Majority of the workforce are private sector employees followed by own account workers. Non agriculture sector covers 76.3 percent of employed population in Sri Lanka, employees and own account workers are highly constraining in that sector.

Table 7 depicts the percentage distribution of male and female employed population by main industry sectors. Highest employment share is in service sector and this is true for both male & female, while the lowest shares are for agriculture sector. Among employed females 23.1 percent is in agriculture sector while this share is 24.0 percent for males.

Figure 2 : Distribution of employed population by employment status and Agriculture/ Non- Agriculture sector, first quarter - 2026

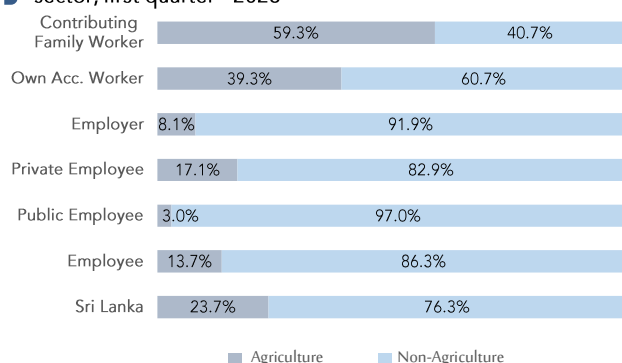


Table 7: Percentage distribution of Employed population by major industry group & gender, first quarter – 2026

Major Industry group	Sri Lanka	Gender	
		Male	Female
Sri Lanka	100.0	100.0	100.0
Agriculture	23.7	24.0	23.1
Industry	25.9	26.0	25.7
Services	50.4	50.0	51.2

Unemployment

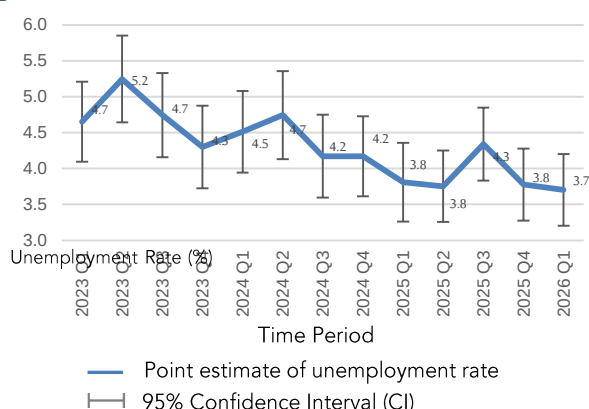
Unemployed

Persons available and/or looking for work, and who did not work and taken steps to find a job during last four weeks and ready to accept a job given a work opportunity within next two weeks are defined as be unemployed.

Unemployment Rate

The proportion of unemployed population to the total labour force.

Figure 3 : Unemployment rates and it's 95% confidence intervals, 2023Q1 - 2026Q1



The number of unemployed persons is estimated as 311,495 during the first quarter 2025. The unemployment rate for the first quarter 2026 is 3.7 percent.

As shown in Figure 3, it is very important to note that, when the changes in unemployment rate is explained the corresponding sampling errors¹ and the confidence limits need to be considered.

Table 8: Number of unemployed and unemployment rate by age group and gender, first quarter - 2026

Age group (Years)	Unemployment Rate (%)			
	Sri Lanka		Gender	
	Number	Sri Lanka	Male	Female
Sri Lanka	311,495	3.7	2.4	6.1
15 - 24	134,117	16.1	14.4	19.2
25 - 29	92,792	11.8	5.7	20.5
Over 30	84,587	1.2	0.5	2.5

*These Figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of Variation) Values are high.

1 Sampling error

When a sample, rather than the entire population, is surveyed, estimates differ from the true values of population they represent. This difference, or sampling error, occurs by chance, and its variability is measured by the sampling error of the estimate.

For more details, please refer the explanatory note given under the labour force link in the DCS website; www.statistics.gov.lk

Figure 4 : Unemployment rate by age group and gender, first quarter 2026



As per the table 8, overall unemployment rate reported for female is 6.1 percent and it is 2.4 percent for male. Youth unemployment rate (age 15 – 24 years) corresponding to the first quarter 2026 is 16.1 percent and that is the highest reported unemployment rate among all age groups. Further the unemployment rates for males and females are 14.4 and 19.2 percent respectively for age group 15 - 24.

The survey results further reveals that the unemployment among females is higher than that of males, in all age groups. Youth and female unemployment contribute more to the overall unemployment of the country.

Table 9: Number of unemployed and unemployment rate by level of education, first quarter - 2026

Level of Education	Unemployment Rate (%)			
	Sri Lanka		Gender	
	Number	Sri Lanka	Male	Female
Sri Lanka	311,495	3.7	2.4	6.1
Below GCE O/L	83,927	1.9	1.6	2.5
GCE O/L	69,594	4.6	3.4*	7.0*
GCE A/L & above	157,974	6.5	3.2	9.7

*These Figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of Variation) Values are high.

Figure 5 : Unemployment rate by level of education and gender, first quarter 2026



The highest unemployment rate is reported from the G.C.E.(A/L) and above group which is 6.5 percent. Corresponding percentages are 3.2 percent and 9.7 percent for males and females respectively. Female unemployment rates are higher than those of males in all levels of education.

Survey results further shows that the problem of unemployment is more acute in the case of educated females than educated males, which was observed consistently over the results of previous survey rounds as well.

Table 1 – Historical table of labour force status (current) of the household population, 15 years of age and over - Both sexes

Year	Household population: (15 years & over)	Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Labour force				Not in labour force Number
				Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	
2017	15,843,735	8,566,686	54.1	8,208,179	95.8	358,507	4.2	7,277,049
2018	16,196,232	8,387,759	51.8	8,015,166	95.6	372,593	4.4	7,808,473
2019	16,424,016	8,592,010	52.3	8,180,693	95.2	411,318	4.8	7,832,006
2020	16,739,396	8,466,606	50.6	7,999,093	94.5	467,513	5.5	8,272,790
2021	17,133,659	8,553,290	49.9	8,113,507	94.9	439,783	5.1	8,580,369
2022	17,161,973	8,547,062	49.8	8,147,731	95.3	399,332	4.7	8,614,911
2023	17,306,492	8,408,331	48.6	8,009,916	95.3	398,415	4.7	8,898,161
2024	17,547,864	8,315,702	47.4	7,949,751	95.6	365,951	4.4	9,232,162
2025	17,034,109	8,408,251	49.4	8,079,040	96.1	329,211	3.9	8,625,859
2024Q1	17,575,175	8,275,154	47.1	7,901,693	95.5	373,461	4.5	9,300,021
2025Q1	16,927,335	8,408,788	49.7	8,086,773	96.2	322,015	3.8	8,518,548
2026Q1	17,089,315	8,414,363	49.2	8,102,868	96.3	311,495	3.7	8,674,952

Table 1 A– Historical table of labour force status (current) of the household population, 15 years of age and over - Male

Year	Household population: (15 years & over)	Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Labour force				Not in labour force Number
				Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	
2017	7,292,047	5,434,510	74.5	5,279,158	97.1	155,352	2.9	1,857,537
2018	7,488,320	5,464,236	73.0	5,300,310	97.0	163,926	3.0	2,024,084
2019	7,610,113	5,554,192	73.0	5,368,896	96.7	185,296	3.3	2,055,920
2020	7,788,634	5,598,004	71.9	5,372,947	96.0	225,057	4.0	2,190,629
2021	7,915,659	5,621,223	71.0	5,414,280	96.3	206,943	3.7	2,294,436
2022	7,914,636	5,580,786	70.5	5,373,965	96.3	206,822	3.7	2,333,850
2023	8,024,760	5,503,595	68.6	5,307,563	96.4	196,032	3.6	2,521,164
2024	8,195,169	5,525,402	67.4	5,358,554	97.0	166,849	3.0	2,669,766
2025	7,889,837	5,449,708	69.1	5,299,777	97.2	149,931	2.8	2,440,129
2024Q1	8,167,457	5,488,120	67.2	5,320,151	96.9	167,969	3.1	2,679,336
2025Q1	7,858,217	5,506,194	70.1	5,367,570	97.5	138,625	2.5	2,352,023
2026Q1	7,817,410	5,401,458	69.1	5,274,509	97.6	126,950	2.4	2,415,951

Table 1B – Historical table of labour force status (current) of the household population, 15 years of age and over - Female

Year	Household population: (15 years & over)	Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Labour force				Not in labour force Number
				Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	Number	Rate (% to total labour force)	
2017	8,551,688	3,132,176	36.6	2,929,021	93.5	203,155	6.5	5,419,512
2018	8,707,912	2,923,523	33.6	2,714,855	92.9	208,667	7.1	5,784,390
2019	8,813,903	3,037,818	34.5	2,811,796	92.6	226,022	7.4	5,776,085
2020	8,950,763	2,868,602	32.0	2,626,146	91.5	242,456	8.5	6,082,161
2021	9,218,000	2,932,067	31.8	2,699,228	92.1	232,840	7.9	6,285,933
2022	9,247,337	2,966,276	32.1	2,773,766	93.5	192,510	6.5	6,281,061
2023	9,281,733	2,904,736	31.3	2,702,354	93.0	202,382	7.0	6,376,997
2024	9,352,695	2,790,299	29.8	2,591,197	92.9	199,102	7.1	6,562,395
2025	9,144,272	2,958,543	32.4	2,779,262	93.9	179,280	6.1	6,185,730
2024Q1	9,407,718	2,787,034	29.6	2,581,542	92.6	205,492	7.4	6,620,684
2025Q1	9,069,118	2,902,593	32.0	2,719,203	93.7	183,390	6.3	6,166,525
2026Q1	9,271,905	3,012,905	32.5	2,828,359	93.9	184,546	6.1	6,259,001

Table 2 - Labour force status (current) of the household population 15 years of age and over, by age – Both sexes

Age	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate	Number	Rate	
					(% to total labour force)		(% to total labour force)	
All ages	17,089,315	8,414,363	49.2	8,102,868	96.3	311,495	3.7	8,674,952
15 – 19 Yrs	1,700,261	144,964	8.5	119,312	82.3	25,652	17.7	1,555,297
20 – 24 Yrs	1,364,069	686,149	50.3	577,684	84.2	108,465	15.8	677,920
25 – 29 Yrs	1,173,228	784,580	66.9	691,788	88.2	92,792	11.8	388,647
30 – 39 Yrs	2,546,629	1,701,915	66.8	1,657,511	97.4	44,404	2.6	844,714
40+ Yrs	10,305,129	5,096,756	49.5	5,056,573	99.2	40,183	0.8	5,208,373

Table 2A - Labour force status (current) of the household population 15 years of age and over, by age – Male

Age	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate	Number	Rate	
					(% to total labour force)		(% to total labour force)	
All ages	7,817,410	5,401,458	69.1	5,274,509	97.6	126,950	2.4	2,415,951
15 – 19 Yrs	878,544	119,571	13.6	100,338	83.9	19,233	16.1	758,973
20 – 24 Yrs	644,004	413,856	64.3	356,198	86.1	57,657	13.9	230,148
25 – 29 Yrs	525,011	460,033	87.6	433,680	94.3	26,354	5.7	64,978
30 – 39 Yrs	1,142,611	1,099,308	96.2	1,088,977	99.1	10,330	0.9	43,303
40+ Yrs	4,627,240	3,308,691	71.5	3,295,316	99.6	13,375	0.4	1,318,549

Table 2B - Labour force status (current) of the household population 15 years of age and over, by age – Female

Age	Household population: (15 years & over)	Labour force						Not in labour force Number
		Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate	Number	Rate	
					(% to total labour force)		(% to total labour force)	
All ages	9,271,905	3,012,905	32.5	2,828,359	93.9	184,546	6.1	6,259,001
15 – 19 Yrs	821,717	25,393	3.1	18,974	74.7	6,419	25.3	796,324
20 – 24 Yrs	720,066	272,293	37.8	221,486	81.3	50,808	18.7	447,772
25 – 29 Yrs	648,216	324,547	50.1	258,109	79.5	66,438	20.5	323,670
30 – 39 Yrs	1,404,018	602,607	42.9	568,534	94.3	34,074	5.7	801,410
40+ Yrs	5,677,889	1,788,065	31.5	1,761,257	98.5	26,808	1.5	3,889,824

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 3 – Historical table of currently employed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Both sexes

Year	All ages	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40+ Yrs
2018	100.0	1.8	7.2	9.0	22.6	59.4
2019	100.0	1.9	7.1	9.3	22.6	59.1
2020	100.0	1.7	6.8	9.2	22.0	60.2
2021	100.0	1.4	6.3	9.4	21.1	61.8
2022	100.0	1.3	6.5	9.0	21.4	61.8
2023	100.0	1.2	6.4	8.4	20.3	63.7
2024	100.0	1.3	6.3	8.7	19.7	64.0
2025	100.0	1.3	6.6	8.6	20.7	62.8
2024Q1	100.0	1.2	6.3	8.8	19.2	64.5
2025Q1	100.0	1.2	6.6	8.8	21.4	62.0
2026Q1	100.0	1.5	7.1	8.5	20.5	62.4

Table 3A – Historical table of currently employed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Male

Year	All ages	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40+ Yrs
2018	100.0	2.0	7.3	9.4	22.6	58.7
2019	100.0	2.1	7.2	9.4	22.3	59.0
2020	100.0	1.9	7.0	9.1	21.8	60.3
2021	100.0	1.6	6.4	9.4	20.5	62.0
2022	100.0	1.3	6.4	9.1	21.2	62.0
2023	100.0	1.4	6.4	8.4	20.0	63.9
2024	100.0	1.4	6.4	8.6	19.3	64.4
2025	100.0	1.4	6.4	8.6	20.4	63.1
2024Q1	100.0	1.3	6.5	8.5	18.5	65.1
2025Q1	100.0	1.3	6.4	8.9	21.6	61.8
2026Q1	100.0	1.9	6.8	8.2	20.6	62.5

Table 3B – Historical table of currently employed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Female

Year	All ages	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40+ Yrs
2018	100.0	1.4	6.9	8.3	22.7	60.7
2019	100.0	1.4	7.0	9.1	23.1	59.4
2020	100.0	1.4	6.5	9.3	22.6	60.1
2021	100.0	1.1	6.0	9.3	22.3	61.4
2022	100.0	1.1	6.8	8.9	21.8	61.4
2023	100.0	0.8	6.4	8.4	20.9	63.4
2024	100.0	1.0	6.1	9.1	20.7	63.1
2025	100.0	1.0	6.9	8.6	21.4	62.1
2024Q1	100.0	0.9	5.7	9.4	20.7	63.2
2025Q1	100.0	1.1	6.9	8.5	21.2	62.3
2026Q1	100.0	0.7	7.8	9.1	20.1	62.3

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 4 – Historical table of currently employed persons by level of education (Percentage) - Both sexes

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & Below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE (O.L)/ NCGE	GCE (A.L)/ HNCE & above
2019	100.0	14.0	45.8	17.4	22.8
2020	100.0	13.7	46.0	17.8	22.5
2021	100.0	13.0	45.7	17.6	23.8
2022	100.0	12.7	45.1	17.6	24.6
2023	100.0	12.6	43.9	18.5	25.1
2024	100.0	11.6	43.6	19.1	25.6
2025	100.0	11.3	42.6	19.0	27.1
2024Q1	100.0	11.3	43.7	19.1	25.9
2025Q1	100.0	11.8	41.9	19.6	26.7
2026Q1	100.0	11.0	42.9	18.0	28.1

Table 4A – Historical table of currently employed persons by level of education (Percentage) - Male

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & Below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE (O.L)/ NCGE	GCE (A.L)/ HNCE & above
2019	100.0	14.1	49.6	18.0	18.2
2020	100.0	13.8	49.8	18.3	18.1
2021	100.0	13.0	49.6	18.6	18.8
2022	100.0	13.0	49.1	18.5	19.4
2023	100.0	12.9	48.0	19.2	19.9
2024	100.0	12.0	47.7	19.9	20.5
2025	100.0	11.3	46.7	20.0	21.9
2024Q1	100.0	11.2	48.2	20.2	20.4
2025Q1	100.0	11.8	46.0	20.2	22.0
2026Q1	100.0	11.4	47.0	19.3	22.4

Table 4B – Historical table of currently employed persons by level of education (Percentage) - Female

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & Below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE (O.L)/ NCGE	GCE (A.L)/ HNCE & above
2019	100.0	13.8	38.4	16.3	31.6
2020	100.0	13.4	38.1	16.8	31.7
2021	100.0	12.8	37.8	15.5	33.8
2022	100.0	12.0	37.2	16.1	34.7
2023	100.0	12.0	35.8	17.0	35.3
2024	100.0	10.8	35.3	17.6	36.3
2025	100.0	11.2	34.6	17.2	37.0
2024Q1	100.0	11.6	34.5	16.9	37.1
2025Q1	100.0	11.8	33.8	18.5	36.0
2026Q1	100.0	10.2	35.3	15.7	38.8

Table 5 – Historical table of currently employed persons by employment status (Percentage) - Both sexes

Year	Total employed	Employee			Employer	Own account worker	Unpaid family worker
		Total	Public	Private			
2019	100.0	57.9	14.9	43.0	2.6	32.5	7.0
2020	100.0	57.5	14.8	42.7	2.5	33.2	6.8
2021	100.0	57.3	15.2	42.0	2.7	33.4	6.6
2022	100.0	58.0	15.1	42.9	2.9	33.1	5.9
2023	100.0	59.0	14.6	44.5	2.6	32.8	5.5
2024	100.0	58.8	14.4	44.4	2.9	33.1	5.2
2025	100.0	60.5	15.2	45.3	3.1	31.8	4.5
2024Q1	100.0	59.2	14.9	44.3	2.7	33.0	5.2
2025Q1	100.0	62.7	16.0	46.7	2.9	30.2	4.2
2026Q1	100.0	61.1	14.5	46.5	3.0	31.3	4.6

Table 5A – Historical table of currently employed persons by employment status (Percentage) - Male

Year	Total employed	Employee			Employer	Own account worker	Unpaid family worker
		Total	Public	Private			
2019	100.0	57.7	12.2	45.5	3.5	36.5	2.3
2020	100.0	56.7	12.0	44.7	3.4	37.5	2.4
2021	100.0	56.6	12.1	44.4	3.7	37.3	2.4
2022	100.0	57.0	11.9	45.1	3.9	37.2	2.0
2023	100.0	57.6	11.5	46.1	3.5	36.8	2.1
2024	100.0	57.2	11.2	46.0	3.8	37.1	1.9
2025	100.0	58.8	12.1	46.7	4.2	35.4	1.5
2024Q1	100.0	58.0	11.7	46.3	3.4	36.4	2.2
2025Q1	100.0	61.3	12.9	48.4	3.8	33.6	1.3
2026Q1	100.0	59.0	10.7	48.3	3.9	35.5	1.6

Table 5B – Historical table of currently employed persons by employment status (Percentage) - Female

Year	Total employed	Employee			Employer	Own account worker	Unpaid family worker
		Total	Public	Private			
2019	100.0	58.3	19.9	38.4	0.8	24.8	16.1
2020	100.0	59.0	20.5	38.5	0.8	24.4	15.8
2021	100.0	58.7	21.5	37.2	0.8	25.4	15.2
2022	100.0	60.0	21.3	38.7	1.0	25.4	13.6
2023	100.0	61.9	20.6	41.2	0.9	25.0	12.2
2024	100.0	62.2	21.2	41.0	1.1	24.9	11.9
2025	100.0	63.7	21.1	42.6	1.1	24.9	10.2
2024Q1	100.0	61.7	21.4	40.2	1.1	25.9	11.4
2025Q1	100.0	65.4	22.1	43.3	1.1	23.7	9.8
2026Q1	100.0	64.9	21.7	43.2	1.3	23.4	10.4

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 6 - Currently Employed person by Industry group (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - both sexes

Year	Total	Industry Group																
		1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2022	8,147,731	2,158,559	58,979	1,408,819	690,401	1,142,754	486,346	235,544	71,054	182,379	87,337	146,494	456,844	461,829	169,298	162,099	157,590	71,404
2023	8,009,916	2,088,344	64,606	1,377,686	600,862	1,127,497	504,645	277,739	78,347	176,891	89,946	135,523	438,156	429,311	185,014	209,128	160,913	65,308
2024	7,949,751	2,066,651	60,445	1,366,492	604,479	1,175,059	521,450	259,043	80,357	158,144	85,106	147,556	419,058	422,348	183,209	200,086	138,315	61,951
2025	8,079,040	1,932,548	52,317	1,439,539	628,599	1,183,675	505,660	268,312	92,347	185,380	94,411	160,868	447,673	466,391	188,544	197,111	168,945	66,718
2024Q1	7,901,693	2,039,574	66,853	1,278,491	604,442	1,161,471	556,339	242,696	63,318	152,521	90,037	154,273	412,578	456,883	210,551	206,449	141,198	64,019
2025Q1	8,086,773	1,889,295	57,958	1,437,994	627,912	1,144,264	494,992	274,312	101,147	224,154	102,880	174,337	449,002	459,259	196,340	207,093	182,241	63,593
2026Q1	8,102,868	1,920,505	56,088	1,425,086	614,930	1,139,485	547,132	319,361	116,287	197,335	80,646	158,151	429,460	442,840	191,206	207,585	184,937	71,833

Table 6A - Currently Employed person by Industry group (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - Male

Year	Total	Industry Group																
		1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2022	5,373,965	1,422,010	58,657	758,623	658,525	831,372	466,203	141,812	48,341	100,235	55,248	104,400	271,425	139,674	61,720	123,033	79,292	53,396
2023	5,307,563	1,418,583	62,801	731,875	574,746	823,014	480,265	167,045	60,945	97,742	57,625	92,927	270,067	127,997	59,902	167,068	62,929	52,031
2024	5,358,554	1,446,096	59,637	737,824	573,276	861,799	498,811	167,564	56,051	89,841	55,073	104,679	253,211	138,581	56,349	158,330	54,071	47,360
2025	5,299,777	1,298,371	51,063	770,468	599,088	848,704	478,836	162,253	66,039	99,579	58,159	111,957	271,223	140,978	68,714	149,377	73,893	51,076
2024Q1	5,320,151	1,422,258	65,370	711,642	560,555	840,721	533,959	156,008	42,090	84,905	60,898	116,221	250,454	156,623	65,463	166,129	35,637	51,217
2025Q1	5,367,570	1,306,414	56,390	767,793	602,952	827,103	472,175	167,265	72,756	121,245	60,163	124,008	257,937	159,433	82,135	159,570	83,545	46,687
2026Q1	5,274,509	1,267,486	50,628	735,997	583,443	821,898	526,206	223,735	73,354	95,662	55,909	108,335	243,742	127,920	61,932	161,240	84,497	52,525

Table 6B - Currently Employed person by Industry group (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - Female

Year	Total	Industry Group																
		1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2022	2,773,766	736,549	322	650,196	31,877	311,382	20,144	93,732	22,712	82,144	32,089	42,094	185,419	322,155	107,578	39,066	78,298	18,009
2023	2,702,354	669,761	1,805	645,812	26,116	304,483	24,381	110,694	17,401	79,150	32,321	42,595	168,089	301,314	125,112	42,060	97,984	13,277
2024	2,591,197	620,555	809	628,668	31,203	313,260	22,639	91,479	24,306	68,303	30,034	42,877	165,847	283,767	126,859	41,756	84,244	14,591
2025	2,779,262	634,177	1,254	669,071	29,511	334,971	26,824	106,059	26,308	85,802	36,253	48,911	176,450	325,413	119,830	47,734	95,053	15,642
2024Q1	2,581,542	617,316	1,483	566,849	43,886	320,750	22,380	86,688	21,228	67,616	29,139	38,051	162,124	300,260	145,088	40,320	105,560	12,802
2025Q1	2,719,203	582,881	1,568	670,201	24,960	317,161	22,818	107,048	28,391	102,910	42,717	50,329	191,066	299,826	114,204	47,523	98,696	16,906
2026Q1	2,828,359	653,019	5,460	689,090	31,487	317,587	20,927	95,626	42,933	101,674	24,737	49,816	185,718	314,920	129,274	46,345	100,440	19,308

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

.. Not reported

Note: These Industry groups are based on ISIC - Rev. 4

1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)

2 Mining & quarrying (B)

3 Manufacturing (C)

6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)

7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)

8 Transportation and storage (H)

9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)

10 Information and communication (J)

11 Financial and insurance activities (K)

13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)

14 Administrative and support service activities (N)

15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)

16 Education (P)

17 Human health and social work activities (Q)

19 Other service activities (S)

20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)

Other

Other

12 Real estate activities (L)

18 Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)

21 Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 6C: Historical table of currently employed population by major industry group - Both sexes

Major Industry Group	Year						
	2022	2023	2024	2025	2024Q1	2025Q1	2026Q1
Total	8,147,731	8,009,916	7,949,751	8,079,040	7,901,693	8,086,773	8,102,868
Agriculture	2,158,559	2,088,344	2,066,651	1,932,548	2,039,574	1,889,295	1,920,505
Industry	2,158,199	2,043,154	2,031,417	2,120,455	1,949,786	2,123,863	2,096,104
Services	3,830,973	3,878,418	3,851,683	4,026,037	3,912,333	4,073,615	4,086,258

Table 6D: Historical table of currently employed population by major industry group (percentage) - Both sexes

Major Industry Group	Year						
	2022	2023	2024	2025	2024Q1	2025Q1	2026Q1
Total	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0	100.0
Agriculture	26.5	26.1	26.0	23.9	25.8	23.4	23.7
Industry	26.5	25.5	25.6	26.2	24.7	26.3	25.9
Services	47.0	48.4	48.5	49.8	49.5	50.4	50.4

Note: These Industry groups are based on ISIC - Rev. 4

Agriculture

1. Agriculture Forestry and Fishery (A)

Industries

1. Mining & Quarrying (B)
2. Manufacturing (C)
3. Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)

Services

1. Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)
2. Transportation and storage (H)
3. Accommodation and food services activities (I)
4. Information and communication (J)
5. Financial and insurance activities (K)
6. Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)
7. Administrative and support service activities (N)
8. Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)
9. Education (P)
10. Human health and social work activities (Q)
11. Other service activities (S)
12. Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)
13. Real estate activities (L) Arts, entertainment and recreation (R) Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 7 - Currently Employed person by Occupation group (Based on ISCO 08) - Both sexes

Year	Total	Occupation group									
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
2021	8,113,507	324,769	576,124	681,988	282,448	947,824	1,308,645	1,142,171	816,954	2,000,483	32,101
2022	8,147,731	340,894	596,432	688,341	296,177	901,590	1,310,662	1,173,642	786,507	2,007,366	46,120
2023	8,009,916	320,025	587,902	690,537	262,986	984,747	1,211,408	1,105,729	759,785	2,056,729	30,068
2024	7,949,751	339,787	589,418	686,022	283,293	978,857	1,212,157	1,077,931	783,781	1,957,410	41,094
2025	8,079,040	371,051	653,873	761,071	260,304	1,003,534	1,108,922	1,099,654	784,008	1,991,179	45,444
2024Q1	7,901,693	304,685	623,962	650,597	293,904	1,014,114	1,164,285	1,070,523	789,030	1,954,603	35,991
2025Q1	8,086,773	387,993	672,165	808,306	257,233	985,422	1,069,546	1,085,775	773,427	1,992,147	54,761
2026Q1*	8,102,868	364,807	652,334	682,663	231,687	1,132,425	1,156,974	1,102,202	852,216	1,897,282	30,279

Table 7A - Currently Employed person by Occupation group (Based on ISCO 08) - Male

Year	Total	Occupation group									
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
2021	5,414,280	261,533	211,883	440,246	133,690	639,288	981,016	843,075	644,676	1,228,363	30,511
2022	5,373,965	264,794	215,652	437,218	141,818	606,381	956,970	835,321	622,142	1,252,138	41,531
2023	5,307,563	252,648	226,462	422,132	118,267	673,020	926,474	770,046	599,409	1,290,760	28,345
2024	5,358,554	249,813	220,360	450,587	135,584	674,946	947,298	763,680	617,928	1,260,484	37,874
2025	5,299,777	270,005	242,189	490,525	111,013	680,751	838,147	770,499	609,397	1,247,136	40,114
2024Q1	5,320,151	220,010	220,227	446,549	150,647	704,851	902,606	756,066	627,007	1,258,938	33,248
2025Q1	5,367,570	279,789	273,451	512,928	105,275	680,874	812,764	757,806	597,264	1,295,278	52,142
2026Q1*	5,274,509	276,560	232,478	410,724	92,179	782,663	864,388	761,062	669,083	1,159,086	26,286

Table 7B - Currently Employed person by Occupation group (Based on ISCO 08) - Female

Year	Total	Occupation group									
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	0
2021	2,699,228	63,236	364,242	241,742	148,758	308,536	327,629	299,096	172,278	772,120	1,590
2022	2,773,766	76,101	380,779	251,123	154,359	295,209	353,692	338,321	164,364	755,227	4,589
2023	2,702,354	67,378	361,440	268,406	144,719	311,727	284,934	335,682	160,376	765,969	1,723
2024	2,591,197	89,974	369,058	235,434	147,709	303,911	264,859	314,251	165,854	696,926	3,221
2025	2,779,262	101,046	411,684	270,545	149,291	322,782	270,775	329,155	174,611	744,042	5,330
2024Q1	2,581,542	84,675	403,734	204,048	143,257	309,262	261,679	314,456	162,023	695,664	2,743
2025Q1	2,719,203	108,204	398,714	295,378	151,959	304,548	256,782	327,969	176,163	696,869	2,619
2026Q1*	2,828,359	88,247	419,856	271,939	139,507	349,762	292,586	341,140	183,133	738,196	3,993

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

* Based on ISCO 08 (Release 2012)

1	Managers, Senior Officials and Legislators	6	Skilled Agriculture, Forestry and Fishery workers
2	Professionals	7	Craft and Related Trades workers
3	Technicians and Associate Professionals	8	Plant and Machine operators and Assemblers
4	Clerks and Clerical support workers	9	Elementary occupations
5	Services and Sales workers	0	Armed Forces Occupations & unidentified occupations

Table 8 - Currently employed persons by hours per week actually worked at the main job and major industrial group (Percentage) - Both sexes

Major industrial group	Total	0 *	1 - 9	10 - 19	20 - 29	30 - 39	40 - 49	50 & Over
Total	100.0	2.4	2.2	4.8	8.5	13.6	36.2	32.3
1	100.0	2.9	4.7	12.2	17.0	20.3	25.9	17.0
2	100.0	3.6	2.0	..	2.7	14.7	35.6	41.4
3	100.0	2.4	2.0	2.5	6.8	9.4	40.8	36.3
6	100.0	2.7	2.0	4.5	9.0	11.4	40.4	30.0
7	100.0	1.6	0.6	1.9	3.5	8.4	32.6	51.5
8	100.0	2.6	1.3	1.7	4.2	8.2	32.3	49.7
9	100.0	1.4	0.6	3.2	5.3	8.9	34.0	46.6
10	100.0	..	1.1	2.3	3.4	7.9	55.9	29.6
11	100.0	2.3	..	0.6	3.1	0.9	70.6	22.4
13	100.0	2.4	1.8	2.8	7.0	11.8	54.0	20.2
14	100.0	1.0	..	1.0	1.6	6.7	33.7	56.0
15	100.0	1.2	0.3	0.4	1.1	7.4	60.6	29.0
16	100.0	4.7	4.6	3.4	10.5	40.7	29.6	6.6
17	100.0	1.4	..	1.6	1.3	5.7	48.8	41.1
19	100.0	4.6	2.4	4.0	11.3	13.7	32.7	31.3
20	100.0	..	1.3	4.8	12.7	21.5	26.7	33.0
Other	100.0	1.4	3.7	3.7	10.6	19.2	40.9	20.6

* Has a job but not at work during the reference week

.. Not reported

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Industry group

1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)

2 Mining & quarrying (B)

3 Manufacturing (C)

6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)

7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)

8 Transportation and storage (H)

9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)

10 Information and communication (J)

11 Financial and insurance activities (K)

13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)

14 Administrative and support service activities (N)

15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)

16 Education (P)

17 Human health and social work activities (Q)

19 Other service activities (S)

20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)

Other

Other

12 Real estate activities (L)

18 Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)

21 Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

Table 9 – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by age groups (Percentage) - Both Sexes

Year	Total	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40 + Yrs
2019	100.0	13.0	36.0	22.8	14.3	13.8
2020	100.0	13.5	39.3	21.5	13.8	12.0
2021	100.0	8.9	42.5	22.2	15.2	11.1
2022	100.0	9.6	37.2	24.4	14.1	14.7
2023	100.0	10.0	35.5	25.3	14.2	15.1
2024	100.0	10.6	35.7	27.1	15.6	10.9
2025	100.0	11.7	35.0	25.0	15.8	12.6
2024Q1	100.0	6.2	34.7	29.6	16.3	13.2
2025Q1	100.0	11.3	37.1	24.9	15.7	11.1
2026Q1	100.0	8.2	34.8	29.8	14.3	12.9

Table 9A– Historical table of currently unemployed persons by age groups (Percentage) – Male

Year	Total	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40 + Yrs
2019	100.0	18.3	38.9	19.5	8.3	15.0
2020	100.0	18.8	41.0	18.6	11.9	9.7
2021	100.0	12.3	45.0	20.0	12.1	10.6
2022	100.0	12.9	38.9	21.2	12.1	14.8
2023	100.0	13.8	36.6	21.5	12.2	15.8
2024	100.0	14.9	37.7	24.1	13.6	9.7
2025	100.0	17.1	37.5	22.1	11.0	12.3
2024Q1	100.0	11.3	36.9	24.3	13.9	13.6
2025Q1	100.0	15.6	36.9	25.3	11.8	10.4
2026Q1	100.0	15.2	45.4	20.8	8.1	10.5

Table 9B – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by age groups (Percentage) – Female

Year	Total	Age groups				
		15 – 19 Yrs	20 – 24 Yrs	25 – 29 Yrs	30 – 39 Yrs	40 + Yrs
2019	100.0	8.7	33.6	25.5	19.3	12.9
2020	100.0	8.5	37.7	24.1	15.6	14.1
2021	100.0	5.8	40.3	24.2	18.0	11.6
2022	100.0	6.1	35.2	27.7	16.3	14.6
2023	100.0	6.2	34.4	28.9	16.0	14.4
2024	100.0	7.0	34.0	29.7	17.4	11.9
2025	100.0	7.1	32.9	27.4	19.8	12.8
2024Q1	100.0	1.9	32.9	34.0	18.2	13.0
2025Q1	100.0	8.0	37.2	24.5	18.5	11.6
2026Q1	100.0	3.5	27.5	36.0	18.5	14.5

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 10 – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by level of education (Percentage) – Both sexes

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE(O/L) NCGE	GCE(A/L) HNCE & Above
2019	100.0	2.9	31.4	23.9	41.9
2020	100.0	2.2	32.6	23.5	41.7
2021	100.0	1.4	29.6	24.9	44.1
2022	100.0	1.8	32.1	23.6	42.6
2023	100.0	1.8	31.1	23.6	43.6
2024	100.0	1.4	26.9	25.0	46.8
2025	100.0	1.9	28.3	27.1	42.7
2024Q1	100.0	1.5	21.7	27.4	49.4
2025Q1	100.0	1.5	26.2	28.8	43.5
2026Q1	100.0	0.8	26.1	22.3	50.7

Table 10A – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by level of education (Percentage) – Male

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE(O/L) NCGE	GCE(A/L) HNCE & Above
2019	100.0	2.9	42.2	27.0	28.0
2020	100.0	2.3	42.2	27.7	28.5
2021	100.0	1.8	36.0	29.9	32.3
2022	100.0	2.2	40.1	28.0	29.6
2023	100.0	2.3	39.3	25.1	33.4
2024	100.0	1.0	33.2	28.0	37.8
2025	100.0	2.4	35.2	31.0	31.4
2024Q1	100.0	1.1	28.3	31.0	39.6
2025Q1	100.0	1.4	32.8	28.6	37.1
2026Q1	100.0	1.3	39.0	28.6	31.1

Table 10B – Historical table of currently unemployed persons by level of education (Percentage) – Female

Year	Total	Level of education			
		Grade 5 & below	Grades 6 - 10	GCE(O/L) NCGE	GCE(A/L) HNCE & Above
2019	100.0	2.9	22.5	21.4	53.3
2020	100.0	2.2	24.2	19.7	53.9
2021	100.0	1.0	23.9	20.5	54.6
2022	100.0	1.3	23.5	18.8	56.4
2023	100.0	1.4	23.1	22.1	53.4
2024	100.0	1.7	21.5	22.4	54.4
2025	100.0	1.5	22.5	23.8	52.1
2024Q1	100.0	1.9	16.3	24.4	57.4
2025Q1	100.0	1.6	21.3	28.9	48.3
2026Q1	100.0	0.5	17.2	18.1	64.2

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 11 – Currently unemployed persons by sex and duration of unemployment

Sex	Total	(2026 1 st Quarter)		
		Duration		
		Less than 6 months	6 to less than 12 months	12+ months
Both sexes	311,495	152,262	81,647	77,587
%	100.0	48.9	26.2	24.9
Male	126,950	64,904	34,963	27,083
%	100.0	51.1	27.5	21.3
Female	184,546	87,358	46,684	50,504
%	100.0	47.3	25.3	27.4

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 12 – Standard error and coefficient of variation of selected variables

	Estimated Value	Standard Error	Coefficient of Variation (%)	Estimated Value (Ratio)	Standard Error	Coefficient of Variation (%)
General labour force characteristics						
Population (15 years & over)	17,089,315	145,654	0.9			
Employed Population	8,102,868	109,158	1.3			
Unemployed Population	311,495	21,954	7.0			
Employment Rate				96.3	0.25	0.26
Unemployment Rate				3.7	0.25	6.85
Labour Force	8,414,363	112,427	1.3			
Not in Labour Force	8,674,952	106,254	1.2			
Employed persons by major industry Groups						
1	1,920,505	72,789	3.8			
2	56,088	11,205	20.0			
3	1,425,086	55,993	3.9			
6	614,930	32,937	5.4			
7	1,139,485	44,882	3.9			
8	547,132	30,401	5.6			
9	319,361	26,102	8.2			
10	116,287	15,019	12.9			
11	197,335	16,790	8.5			
13	80,646	12,280	15.2			
14	158,151	17,142	10.8			
15	429,460	29,076	6.8			
16	442,840	28,514	6.4			
17	191,206	17,094	8.9			
19	207,585	19,080	9.2			
20	184,937	19,853	10.7			
Other	71,833	9,812	13.7			
Unemployed persons by level of education						
Grade 5 and below	2,604	1,629	62.5			
Grade 6 - 10	81,323	9,276	11.4			
G.C.E.(O/L)/N.C.G.E.	69,594	7,775	11.2			
G.C.E.(A/L)/H.N.C.E. & above	157,974	11,876	7.5			
Industry group						
1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)						
2 Mining & quarrying (B)						
3 Manufacturing (C)						
6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)						
7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)						
8 Transportation and storage (H)						
9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)						
10 Information and communication (J)						
11 Financial and insurance activities (K)						
13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)						
14 Administrative and support service activities (N)						
15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)						
16 Education (P)						
17 Human health and social work activities (Q)						
19 Other service activities (S)						
20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)						
Other						
	Other					
	Real estate activities (L)					
	Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)					
	Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)					

Special Statistical Appendix

Explanatory Notes

Coverage

Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey was designed to measure the levels and trends of employment, unemployment and labour force in Sri Lanka. This survey is being conducted quarterly, since the first quarter of 1990.

This quarterly survey of households is conducted through a scientifically selected sample designed to represent the civilian non-institutional population. Respondents are interviewed to obtain information about the employment status etc. of each member of the household 15 years of age and older.

The field work of the survey is done during the third week of each month, Monday through Sunday. This is known as the "survey week". The inquiry relates to activity or status are referred in the preceding week of the survey week; referred to as the "reference week".

The concepts and definitions underlying labour force data are as follows.

Concepts & Definitions

1. **Labour force:** The labour force is composed of the economically active population 15 years of age and over.
2. **The Economically Active Population:** is defined as those persons who are/were employed or unemployed during the reference period of the survey.
3. **Employed:** Persons, who during the reference period, worked as paid employees, employers, own account workers (self employed), or unpaid family workers are said to be employed. This includes persons with a job but not at work during the reference period.
4. **Unemployed:** Persons who are seeking and available for work, but had no employment during the reference period.
5. **Currently Economically Active:** A person who was employed or unemployed during the current reference period is considered to be currently economically active.
6. **Not in the Labour Force (not economically active):** Persons who were neither working nor available/looking for work are classified as "not in the labour force". Persons are not in the labour force for such reasons as: full time care of the household, full – time students, retired or old age, infirmed or disabled, or are not interested in working for one reason or another. Current and Usual definitions apply.
7. **Criteria for classification of underemployment:** In order to classify an employed persons as visibly underemployed,

*Explanatory Notes (Page 2)****(i) If the person has worked less than the normal duration in his/her main activity***

In Sri Lanka scenario, 35 hours per week is taken as the cut-off point applicable to all workers, except government teachers. As in practice, though teachers do have a normal duration of work which is below the general cut-off point, they should be on a full time schedule according to the nature of their job. Further, those who do have a secondary job or those who are employers, were considered as having worked the normal duration in their respective activity.

Therefore, if the person has worked less than the normal duration in his/her activity (as described above), then the person is further questioned to ascertain whether he/She is prepared and available for further work if provided. Such persons are considered underemployed in their respective employment.

(ii) If the person has worked more than the normal duration in his/her activity

If the person has worked even more than 35 hours as usually, but he has worked less than 35 hours actually in the reference period, only due to the off season or bad weather, such persons were also further questioned to check their underemployment situation, considering them as a special category.

8. Informal Sector Employment

In order to classify a person to be employed in informal sector employment, following information were used.

- (i) Registration of the organization
- (ii) Accounts keeping practices of the organization
- (iii) Total number of regular employees of the organization.

Reliability of the estimates

Statistics based on the quarterly labour force data are subject to both sampling and non - sampling errors. When a sample rather than the entire population is surveyed, there is a chance that the sample estimates may differ from the "true" population values they represent.

The exact differences or sampling error, varies depending on the particular sample selected, and this variability is measured by the standard error of the estimate. There is about a 95 percent chance, or level of confidence, that an estimate based on a sample will differ by no more than 1.96 standard errors from the "true" population value, because of sampling error. Analyses relating to the Labour Force Survey are generally conducted at the 95 percent level of confidence.

For example, the confidence interval for the quarterly unemployment rate is calculated as follows

When the estimated unemployment rate is 4.5 and standard error of unemployment rate is 0.275 then 95% confidence interval

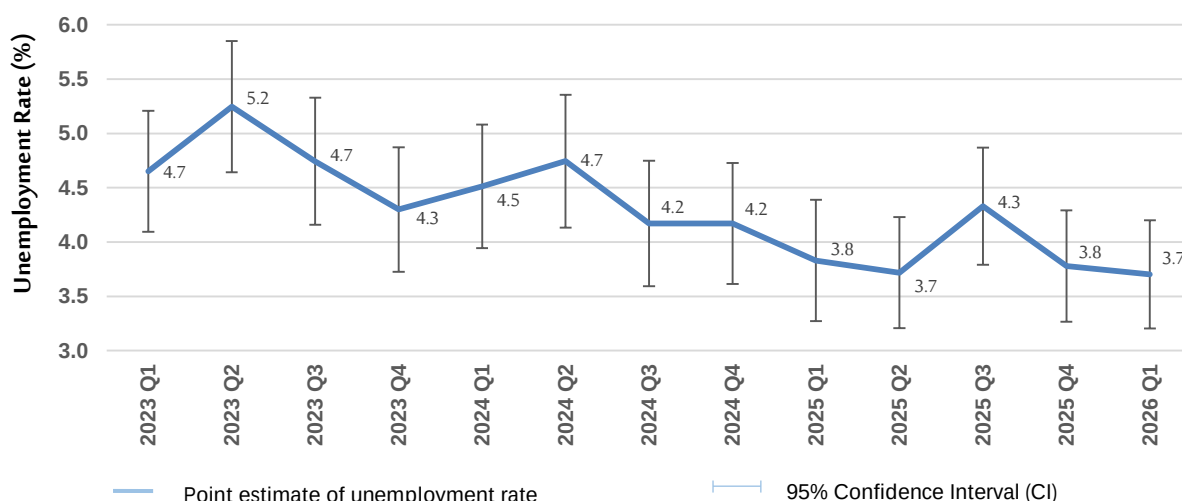
Estimated value (of the unemployment rate) $\pm$ (standard error) * (1.96)

4.5 $\pm$ (0.275) * (1.96)
(4.5 $\pm$ 0.539)

Explanatory Notes (Page 3)

This means, the 95 percent confidence interval on the quarterly unemployment rate could range from (4.0 to 5.0). This implies that there is about 95 percent chance that the "true" unemployment rate lies within this interval. This range includes all the values range from 4.0 to 5.0. When the comparison of this estimate is done between two quarters, if any of the value within the 95 percent confidence interval of one quarter overlaps with the confidence interval of the other, it means that the estimates of this two quarters are not significantly different.

Therefore, in each quarterly labour force report, a separate table is given including approximate standard errors for some selected variables, so that users could understand this statistical scenario clearly.

Distribution of unemployment rates and 95% confidence intervals (2023Q1- 2026Q1)

As seen in figure, it is very important to note that, there were no statistically significant differences between the unemployment rates reported in different time periods of 2023/2026, when sampling error was considered.

Change in survey schedule

Current survey concepts and methods are very similar to those introduced at the beginning of the survey in 1990. However, some changes have been made over the years to improve the accuracy and usefulness of the data. In January 2006, some improvements were made to the labour force survey schedule in order to fulfill the requirements of data users and also to provide additional information for planning purposes. The revision was made focusing on literacy, household economic activities, and informal sector employment and under employment etc.

From January , 2013 onwards, the lower bound of working age populations is considered as age 15, hence age 15 and over population is considered as working age population. The survey schedule is updated to obtain more precise information on following age, informal employment, informal sector, secondary occupation, wages & income , unemployment & trainings.

New Industry & Occupation classifications

From January 2013 onward the survey uses new industry & occupation classifications, such as
 SLIC Rev 4:- Sri Lanka Standard Industry Classification based on International Standard Industry classification - Rev.4 (ISIC Rev 4)
 SLSCO 08:- Sri Lanka Standard Classification of Occupation-2008 based on International Standard Classification of Occupation-2008 (ISCO 2008)

Explanatory Notes (Page 4)

Note :

It is important to note that, all the data published here are the estimates based on a sample survey and these are subject to sampling errors. These sampling errors can be statistically evaluated from the survey results. Therefore, sampling error is normally measured in terms of the standard error of the particular variable. Standard error could be used to calculate the confidence limits with a prescribed accuracy where the true value of the estimates lies.

Further reliability of the estimates can be expressed in terms of Coefficient of Variation (CV). The CV is a relative measure of the sampling error and is calculated as sampling error divided by the expected value of the given characteristic.

In view of this, following table is given to show the estimates for some selected variables, it's standard error, CV and 95% Confidence interval.

It is also important to note that all the estimates we publish in this report are subject to sampling error and one should be cautious in the interpretation of results, especially with respect to the trends over time.

Estimate of Confidence Intervals for some selected characteristics

Year	Labour Force					Employed				
	No.	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.		No.	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.	
				Lower	Upper				Lower	Upper
2019	8,592,010	54,293	0.63	8,485,546	8,698,475	8,180,693	52,108	0.64	8,078,513	8,282,872
2020	8,466,606	58,917	0.70	8,351,075	8,582,137	7,999,093	56,610	0.71	7,888,086	8,110,101
2021	8,553,290	58,311	0.68	8,438,947	8,667,633	8,113,507	56,072	0.69	8,003,555	8,223,460
2022	8,547,062	58,034	0.68	8,433,262	8,660,862	8,147,731	56,377	0.69	8,037,181	8,258,281
2023	8,408,331	60,811	0.72	8,289,086	8,527,576	8,009,916	58,584	0.73	7,895,039	8,124,794
2024	8,315,702	59,437	0.71	8,199,151	8,432,253	7,949,751	57,380	0.72	7,837,234	8,062,267
2025	8,408,251	56,320	0.67	8,297,811	8,518,690	8,079,040	54,626	0.68	7,971,922	8,186,157
2024Q1	8,275,154	121,902	1.47	8,035,740	8,514,568	7,901,693	117,778	1.49	7,670,377	8,133,008
2025Q1	8,408,788	320,507	3.81	7,780,292	9,037,283	8,086,773	308,410	3.81	7,481,999	8,691,547
2026Q1	8,414,363	112,427	1.34	8,193,543	8,635,183	8,102,868	109,158	1.35	7,888,468	8,317,267

Year	Unemployed					Unemployment Rate				
	No.	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.		Rate	Standard error	C.V (%)	95% C.I.	
				Lower	Upper				Lower	Upper
2019	411,318	12,814	3.12	386,191	436,444	4.8	0.1	3.00	4.5	5.1
2020	467,513	14,029	3.00	440,004	495,022	5.5	0.2	2.88	5.2	5.8
2021	439,783	13,930	3.17	412,468	467,097	5.1	0.2	3.05	4.8	5.4
2022	399,332	13,022	3.26	373,797	424,867	4.7	0.1	3.17	4.4	5.0
2023	398,415	13,036	3.27	372,852	423,978	4.7	0.1	3.15	4.4	5.0
2024	365,951	12,835	3.51	340,782	391,120	4.4	0.1	3.39	4.1	4.7
2025	329,211	11,634	3.53	306,397	352,025	3.9	0.1	3.43	3.7	4.2
2024Q1	373,461	24,804	6.64	324,747	422,175	4.5	0.3	6.41	3.9	5.1
2025Q1	322,015	27,245	8.46	268,589	375,440	3.8	0.3	7.43	3.3	4.4
2026Q1	311,495	21,954	7.05	268,375	354,616	3.7	0.3	6.85	3.2	4.2

Alternative estimates

Alternative Estimates of Employment, Unemployment and Labour Force Characteristics

Official employment, unemployment and labour force characteristics are estimated at the Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey, based on the internationally comparable concepts and definitions recommended by the ILO. However the validity of the concepts and definitions used at the survey is questioned very often in some forums, for the appropriateness of these concepts and definitions in the Sri Lankan context.

The concepts and definitions, which were found to be controversial, are as below.

- (1) **Number of Hours of Work** : A person who work **at least one hour** during the reference week, is considered **employed**, under these definitions.
- (2) **Working Age Population** : All persons of **age 10 years and over** are considered to be in the working age, before 2013. However, this was changed as **age 15 and over** from 2013 onward.
- (3) **Employment Status** : All,
 - a) Paid employees, (those who work for wages/salaries).
 - b) Employers (who have at least one paid employee under them).
 - c) Own account workers (who carry out the economic activity without having anypaid employees).
 - d) Contributing family workers (who make their contribution to the economic activities carried out by their own household, without wages/salaries).

The validity of the above concepts and definitions is raised due to the following reasons.

- (1) **Number of Hours of Work** : Some pointed out that one hour per week is too low, to consider a person to be employed.
- (2) **Working Age Population** : Some pointed out those persons in the age group 10-14 yrs. are too young to be considered in the working age. (From 2013 onward the working age population is considered as age 15 and over).
- (3) **Employment Status** : Some pointed out that 'contributing family workers' may work in the family enterprise without payment because they have no other work, and so it is not appropriate to consider them as employed.

An attempt has been made to produce '**Alternative estimates of Employment, Unemployment and Labour Force Characteristics**,' by revising the original concepts and definitions so that the above issues are addressed as explained below.

The revisions made are,

- (1) **Number of Hours of Work** : Persons who work **20 hours or more per week only** are considered to be employed.
- (2) **Contributing Family Worker** : Contributing family workers are **not** considered as employed. They are considered as **economically inactive** (not in the labour force) so only, **a) paid employees b) employers and c) own account workers are considered to be employed.**

Following tables are based on the above alternative concepts and definitions.

Alternative estimates of employment, unemployment and labour force characteristics

Table 1 - Labour force status of household population 15 years & over (Alternative estimates)

Year	Household population (15 years & over)	Total labour force	Labour force partici: rate (%)	Labour Force				Not in labour Force Number
				Employed		Unemployed		
				Number	Rate (%) to total labour force)	Number	Rate (%) to total labour force)	
2016	15,448,679	7,325,972	47.4	6,962,973	95.0	362,999	5.0	8,122,707
2017	15,843,735	7,474,883	47.2	7,116,376	95.2	358,507	4.8	8,368,851
2018	16,196,232	7,428,999	45.9	7,056,406	95.0	372,593	5.0	8,767,233
2019	16,424,016	7,609,700	46.3	7,198,383	94.6	411,318	5.4	8,814,316
2020	16,739,396	7,438,037	44.4	6,970,524	93.7	467,513	6.3	9,301,359
2021	17,133,659	7,471,067	43.6	7,031,284	94.1	439,783	5.9	9,662,592
2022	17,161,973	7,497,884	43.7	7,098,552	94.7	399,332	5.3	9,664,089
2023	17,306,492	7,380,485	42.6	6,982,070	94.6	398,415	5.4	9,926,008
2024	17,547,864	7,445,218	42.4	7,079,267	95.1	365,951	4.9	10,102,646
2025	17,034,109	7,538,839	44.3	7,209,628	95.6	329,211	4.4	9,495,271
2024Q1	17,575,175	7,386,041	42.0	7,012,580	94.9	373,461	5.1	10,189,133
2025Q1	16,927,335	7,635,446	45.1	7,313,432	95.8	322,015	4.2	9,291,889
2026Q1	17,089,315	7,542,235	44.1	7,230,740	95.9	311,495	4.1	9,547,079

Table 2- Historical table of number and rate of unemployment by age (Alternative estimates)

Year	Total		Age group									
			15 - 19		20 - 24		25 - 29		30 - 39		40 & above	
	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate	No.	Rate
2016	362,999	5.0	58,622	32.8	144,156	22.2	76,624	10.0	47,956	2.7	35,640	0.9
2017	358,507	4.8	46,016	25.1	135,121	19.7	79,727	10.4	53,053	3.0	44,590	1.1
2018	372,593	5.0	52,624	30.4	144,824	22.1	84,000	11.3	55,853	3.3	35,291	0.8
2019	411,318	5.4	53,652	29.3	148,046	22.4	93,793	11.8	59,009	3.4	56,818	1.3
2020	467,513	6.3	62,910	38.0	183,722	27.5	100,359	13.0	64,493	3.9	56,029	1.3
2021	439,783	5.9	39,102	30.8	187,104	29.7	97,631	12.5	66,973	4.2	48,972	1.1
2022	399,332	5.3	38,456	32.0	148,378	23.8	97,317	12.6	56,437	3.5	58,743	1.3
2023	398,415	5.4	39,737	33.5	141,290	24.0	100,763	14.2	56,381	3.7	60,244	1.4
2024	365,951	4.9	38,809	32.7	130,640	22.4	99,305	13.5	57,229	3.8	39,968	0.9
2025	329,211	4.4	38,391	30.7	115,218	19.4	82,274	11.4	51,923	3.2	41,404	0.9
2024Q1	373,461	5.1	22,997	23.1	129,609	22.3	110,668	15.1	60,718	4.2	49,469	1.1
2025Q1	322,015	4.2	36,273	31.6	119,386	19.6	80,143	10.7	50,428	3.0	35,785	0.8
2026Q1	311,495	4.1	25,652	19.4	108,465	16.9	92,792	12.8	44,404	2.8	40,183	0.9

These figures are to be treated with caution as the corresponding CV (Coefficient of variation) values are high.

Table 3 - Currently Employed persons by Industry group (No. and percentage) (Based on ISIC Fourth Revision) - (Alternative estimates)

Year		Total	Industry group																
			1	2	3	6	7	8	9	10	11	13	14	15	16	17	19	20	Other
2022	No.	7,098,552	1,624,304	54,869	1,273,780	626,142	1,021,153	450,290	195,864	69,084	179,777	81,766	135,361	449,381	429,513	164,503	142,340	135,921	64,505
	%	100.0	22.9	0.8	17.9	8.8	14.4	6.3	2.8	1.0	2.5	1.2	1.9	6.3	6.1	2.3	2.0	1.9	0.9
2023	No.	6,982,070	1,565,483	60,338	1,242,417	539,663	994,013	476,430	239,278	77,115	174,986	84,258	126,467	435,718	403,080	181,525	182,460	141,912	56,928
	%	100.0	22.4	0.9	17.8	7.7	14.2	6.8	3.4	1.1	2.5	1.2	1.8	6.2	5.8	2.6	2.6	2.0	0.8
2024	No.	7,079,267	1,617,302	58,145	1,249,437	561,979	1,050,283	499,891	230,156	78,001	156,020	81,737	144,857	415,785	396,749	179,543	182,482	121,181	55,717
	%	100.0	22.8	0.8	17.6	7.9	14.8	7.1	3.3	1.1	2.2	1.2	2.0	5.9	5.6	2.5	2.6	1.7	0.8
2025	No.	7,209,628	1,500,389	50,792	1,313,030	585,209	1,075,471	482,739	238,490	89,786	179,247	88,096	153,113	441,530	437,326	186,368	179,229	149,863	58,951
	%	100.0	20.8	0.7	18.2	8.1	14.9	6.7	3.3	1.2	2.5	1.2	2.1	6.1	6.1	2.6	2.5	2.1	0.8
2024Q1	No.	7,012,580	1,574,861	63,758	1,161,145	558,130	1,037,713	529,422	219,045	63,318	151,094	83,846	154,273	408,904	432,936	204,917	191,894	122,607	54,715
	%	100.0	22.5	0.9	16.6	8.0	14.8	7.5	3.1	0.9	2.2	1.2	2.2	5.8	6.2	2.9	2.7	1.7	0.8
2025Q1	No.	7,313,432	1,486,053	53,587	1,341,275	587,304	1,055,296	475,359	244,350	97,379	222,211	96,050	170,485	444,826	437,087	196,340	186,482	160,483	58,865
	%	100.0	20.3	0.7	18.3	8.0	14.4	6.5	3.3	1.3	3.0	1.3	2.3	6.1	6.0	2.7	2.5	2.2	0.8
2026Q1	No.	7,230,740	1,430,224	54,975	1,326,217	575,013	1,044,052	529,422	286,458	112,372	196,107	75,375	154,267	426,209	405,698	186,448	190,073	172,507	65,324
	%	100.0	19.8	0.8	18.3	8.0	14.4	7.3	4.0	1.6	2.7	1.0	2.1	5.9	5.6	2.6	2.6	2.4	0.9

Note: The tabulation groups based on ISIC (Rev.4) are indicated as A,B,C.....U. Due to the limitations on reliability (based on CV), some of these groups have been combined.

Industry Group

1 Agriculture, forestry and fishing (A)

2 Mining & quarrying (B)

3 Manufacturing (C)

6 Construction, Electricity, gas, steam and air conditioning supply, Water supply, sewerage, waste management and remediation activities (D, E,F)

7 Wholesale and retail trade, repair of motor vehicles and motor cycles(G)

8 Transportation and storage (H)

9 Accommodation and food services activities (I)

10 Information and communication (J)

11 Financial and insurance activities (K)

13 Professional, scientific and technical activities (M)

14 Administrative and support service activities (N)

15 Public administration and defence compulsory social security (O)

16 Education (P)

17 Human health and social work activities (Q)

19 Other service activities (S)

20 Activities of households as employers; undifferentiated goods and services - producing activities of households for own use (T)

Other

Other

12 Real estate activities (L)

18 Arts, entertainment and recreation (R)

21 Activities of extra territorial organizations & bodies (U)

2026

Sri Lanka Labour Force Survey Quarterly Report 1st Quarter

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